Errata for *Research Design in the Social Sciences: Declaration, Diagnosis, and Redesign*

Issues with the printed book

Twenty-one entries, in the order of the errata page of the book website, book.declaredesign.org/errata.html, under its three headings. The authors published every entry; this note carries them unchanged. Bold marks the tokens that changed in prose; a change inside code is stated in words. The book is *Research Design in the Social Sciences: Declaration, Diagnosis, and Redesign* (Princeton University Press, 2023; ISBN 9780691199573, no DOI), by Graeme Blair, Alexander Coppock, and Macartan Humphreys. The repository `active-maintenance-aec/blair_coppock_humphreys_2023` verifies and maintains the book's deposited code at github.com/active-maintenance-aec/blair_coppock_humphreys_2023, archived at Zenodo as doi:10.5281/zenodo.24168284.

Errata

These errata are errors in the printed book. These changes are implemented in the online version.

1. A cross-reference to the wrong section (pg. 53, footnote 1)

> Here we are referring to an 'inquiry model' not a 'reference model,' as discussed in Section **2.2.1**

Corrected: Here we are referring to an 'inquiry model' not a 'reference model,' as discussed in Section **2.1.1**

2. Function names and arguments in Table 8.1 (pg. 69, Table 8.1)

> Row 1: `simple_rs(N = 100, p = .25)`. Row 2: `simple_rs(N = 100, p = 0.25)`. Row 4: `cluster_ra`. Row 6: `cluster_ra` and `strata_ra`.

Corrected: Row 1: `simple_rs(N = 100, prob = .25)`. Row 2: `complete_rs(N = 100, n = 25)`. Row 4: `cluster_rs`. Row 6: `cluster_rs` and `strata_rs`.

Thanks to Bjorn Van Campenhout for identifying the first two errors.

3. A misspelling of revisit (pg. 89)

> to intensively **revist** a subset of attritors

Corrected: to intensively **revisit** a subset of attritors

4. A garbled definition of the p-value (pg. 101)

> The p-value is the probability **this also goes with the misplaced section** estimates of 15 or larger

Corrected: The p-value is the probability **under the null model of obtaining** estimates of 15 or larger.

5. A capital N for a lowercase n in a code block (pg. 158)

> The second code block, which includes the code `MASS::mvrnorm`, reads `N = 1000`.

Corrected: The second code block, which includes the code `MASS::mvrnorm`, reads `n = 1000`.

6. Swapped potential outcomes in Declarations 16.5 and 16.6 (pgs. 221-224)

> Declaration 16.5 and Declaration 16.6 **switched the values of the treated and control potential outcomes when X = 0 with the values when X is at the cutoff**.

On pgs. 221-224: We corrected an error in Declaration 16.5 and Declaration 16.6 that erroneously switched the values of the treated and control potential outcomes when X = 0 with the values when X is at the cutoff. We modified Declaration 16.5 and Figure 16.9 to describe the design with respect to the cutoff and updated the figure caption and text to reflect these changes.

7. A function call missing its parentheses (pg. 225)

> The last line of the code reads `diagnose_designs`.

Corrected: The last line of the code reads `diagnose_designs()`.

8. A lowercase part (pg. 26)

> In **part** IV on the research design lifecycle

Corrected: In **Part** IV on the research design lifecycle

9. A misspelling of inquiries (pg. 53)

These complex **inquires** are made up of a series of atomic inquiries

Corrected: These complex **inquiries** are made up of a series of atomic inquiries

10. Casual for causal (pg. 237)

conjoint experiments target descriptive, rather than **casual**, inquiries

Corrected: conjoint experiments target descriptive, rather than **causal**, inquiries

11. A chapter number for a section number (pg. 273)

the local average treatment effect (LATE) described in **Chapter** 16.4

Corrected: the local average treatment effect (LATE) described in **Section** 16.4

12. A misspelling of bolster (pg. 309)

how leaders allocate cabinet positions to **bolseter** coalitions

Corrected: how leaders allocate cabinet positions to **bolster** coalitions

13. A doubled also (pg. 340)

They also told us **also** that they believed

Corrected: They also told us that they believed

14. Moderations for moderators in a quotation (pg. 343)

other pertinent **moderations** beyond gender and LGBTQ+ status

Corrected: other pertinent **moderators** beyond gender and LGBTQ+ status
The sentence is in the quotation from Bonilla and Tillery (2020).

15. A misspelling of convey (pg. 348)

covey the entirety of *MIDA* in one sentence

Corrected: convey the entirety of *MIDA* in one sentence

16. A reference to the power formula removed (pgs. 124-125)

> The text refers to the power formula from Gerber and Green (2012).

On pgs. 124-125: We removed a reference to the power formula from Gerber and Green (2012). We now discuss a generic restatement of statistical power.

Substantive changes

17. The inquiry changed from the ATE to the ATT (pgs. 210-211)

> Declaration 16.2 declares the **ATE** as the inquiry.

On pg. 210-211, we changed the inquiry to be the ATT rather than the ATE, to reflect the more common practice of targeting the ATT in matching designs. Declaration 16.2 now declares the ATT as the inquiry; we now write "Our inquiry is the average treatment effect on the treated (ATT). This is the average treatment effect among the units who are in fact treated."; and Figure 16.4 is updated to reflect the change in the x-axis title.

Code updates

We are committed to maintaining the code in this book as the R ecosystem evolves. The following changes reflect differences between the printed book and the online version.

18. Declaration 9.3 and the tidying of stan objects (pg. 103)

> Declaration 9.3 reads `.summary = ~tidy_stan(., exponentiate = TRUE)` and loads the library `rdss`.

On pg. 103, Declaration 9.3 now reads `.summary = ~tidy(., exponentiate = TRUE)` instead of `.summary = ~tidy_stan(., exponentiate = TRUE)`, reflecting the use of the standard `broom.mixed` package for tidying stan objects. In addition, the library `rdss` is replaced with the library `broom.mixed` in the declaration.

19. The panel data example and fabricatr 2.0 (pg. 155)

> The panel data example declares the years level with `add_level(nest = FALSE)` and joins it to countries with `by = join_using(countries, years)`.

On pg. 155, the panel data example now declares the years level with `declare_level()` and joins it to countries with `cross_levels(.by = c("countries", "years"))`, in place of `add_level(nest = FALSE)` and `by = join_using(countries, years)`. fabricatr 2.0 deprecates the old form; the new one draws the same data.

20. Declaration 16.3 and DIDmultiplegt 2.x (pgs. 212-213)

> Declaration 16.3 calls `DIDmultiplegt` with `Y`, `G`, `T`, and `D`, and declares the periods level with `add_level(nest = FALSE)` and `by = join_using(units, periods)`.

On pgs. 212-213, Declaration 16.3 now uses the `DIDmultiplegt` 2.x interface through `rdss::did_multiplegt_tidy()` (`mode = "dyn"` with `outcome`, `group`, `time`, and `treatment` in place of `Y`, `G`, `T`, and `D`), which requires the `polars` package. The periods level is declared with `declare_level()` and joined with `cross_levels(.by = c("units", "periods"))`, the fabricatr 2.0 form of `add_level(nest = FALSE)` and `by = join_using(units, periods)`.

21. Declaration 18.10 and estimatr 2.0 (pgs. 284-285)

> Declaration 18.10 calls `declare_estimator()` without `se_type`, and declares the periods level with `add_level(nest = FALSE)` and `by = join_using(units, periods)`.

On pgs. 284-285, Declaration 18.10 now writes `se_type = "CR2"` in its `declare_estimator()` call. Under estimatr 1.x, a fit with both `fixed_effects` and `clusters` used CR2 standard errors by default, so this is the estimator the printed book ran; estimatr 2.0 changed that default to CR0 and warns when the choice is left implicit. Naming CR2 keeps the diagnosis as printed and removes the warning. The periods level is now declared with `declare_level()` and joined with `cross_levels(.by = c("units", "periods"))`, the fabricatr 2.0 form of `add_level(nest = FALSE)` and `by = join_using(units, periods)`; the data drawn are the same.

Due to final copyediting by the Press, the website version may differ slightly from the print version. If you discover a discrepancy, please email the authors at graeme.blair@gmail.com, acoppock@gmail.com, and macartan@gmail.com.

Changes to the code that draws the figures

These are not errata. They describe the figure scripts in the deposited replication archive, doi.org/10.7910/DVN/HYVPO5, and not code printed in the book. They are not on the book website and they are not counted in `errata_entries.csv` or in any errata total. The repository generates them from its reproduction ground truth, in `code_updates/build_code_updates.R`.

17 of the 82 figure scripts in the deposited archive no longer run under current R. Every one of them is an ecosystem change rather than an error in the book: no figure is wrong, and the maintained rewrite reproduces all 82. The first five bullets below account for those 17 scripts. The sixth is a separate case that raises no error, so no script-level record reaches it.

- The DAG figures are drawn through a `make_dag_df()` helper that joins `ggdag::tidy_dagitty()` output onto a node table. `tidy_dagitty()` now returns its own `x` and `y` columns, so that join produces `x.x` and `x.y` and the plot fails with `object 'x' not found`. The helper now takes the coordinates from the tidied object rather than joining them in. Affects 13 figures: Figure 2.1 and 5.1, Figure 6.1, Figure 6.2, Figure 8.1, Figure 8.7, Figure 10.1, Figure 15.1, Figure 16.1, Figure 16.7, Figure 16.8, Figure 17.1, Figure 18.1, Figure 18.9.

- Figure 21.2: `dplyr::summarise()` no longer returns more rows than groups, and the utility calculation returns 2,000 rows per group. It now uses `reframe()`, which is the function dplyr introduced for that case.
- Figure 18.12: `vayr::sunflower()` renamed its `width` and `height` arguments to `density` and `aspect_ratio`.
- Figure 18.16: the `interference` package is no longer on CRAN and installs from GitHub at `szonszein/interference`. Loading `ggspatial` in the same session also needs `Sys.setenv(RGL_USE_NULL = TRUE)`.
- Figure 16.6: `DIDmultiplegt` pulls in `rgl`, which fails to load without system OpenGL, so `Sys.setenv(RGL_USE_NULL = TRUE)` is set before it is loaded. The same figure used `..count..`, which ggplot2 has deprecated in favour of `after_stat(count)`. The book website's errata page no longer carries an `RGL_USE_NULL` note: its 2026-10-26 port of Declaration 16.3 (pp. 212-213) to `DIDmultiplegt` 2.x needs `polars` rather than `rgl`. The note here therefore applies to the deposited figure script and not to the printed declaration.
- `code/declarations/declaration_18.10.R` and `code/declarations/declaration_16.3.R` declare their potential outcomes inside `cross_levels()`. fabricatr 2.0 renamed that function's `by =` argument to `.by`, and R will not partial-match a supplied `by` to a formal whose name begins with a dot. So `by =` falls through into `...`, `.by` is left unfilled, and R binds the first *unnamed* argument to it positionally. In both these files that argument is the `potential_outcomes()` call. fabricatr's deprecation shim then reads `by` back out of the dots and returns it, discarding whatever had landed in `.by` without a word, so the design runs to completion with no `Y_Z_0` and no `Y_Z_1` column. **This is the only entry here that fails silently rather than with an error.** Figure 18.12 does raise `object 'Y_Z_0' not found` further down, which is the good case; `declaration_16.3.R` is sourced by nothing in the archive, and a reader who adapts it and never references the potential outcomes gets no signal at all. Two other deposited files, `code/figures/figure_16.6.R` and `code/diagnoses/diagnosis_16.4.R`, use the same deprecated `by =` and are unaffected, because their `cross_levels()` has no unnamed argument to displace: that contrast is the whole diagnosis. The repair belongs in fabricatr and has been made there; until a release carries it, write `.by = c("units", "periods")` in place of `by = join_using(units, periods)`. The book website's entries for Declaration 16.3 (pp. 212-213) and Declaration 18.10 (pp. 284-285) now carry the `.by` form, so that change is published.